GLOBAL MENTORSHIP INITIATIVE

Sessions 6 – 7 – Student Guide

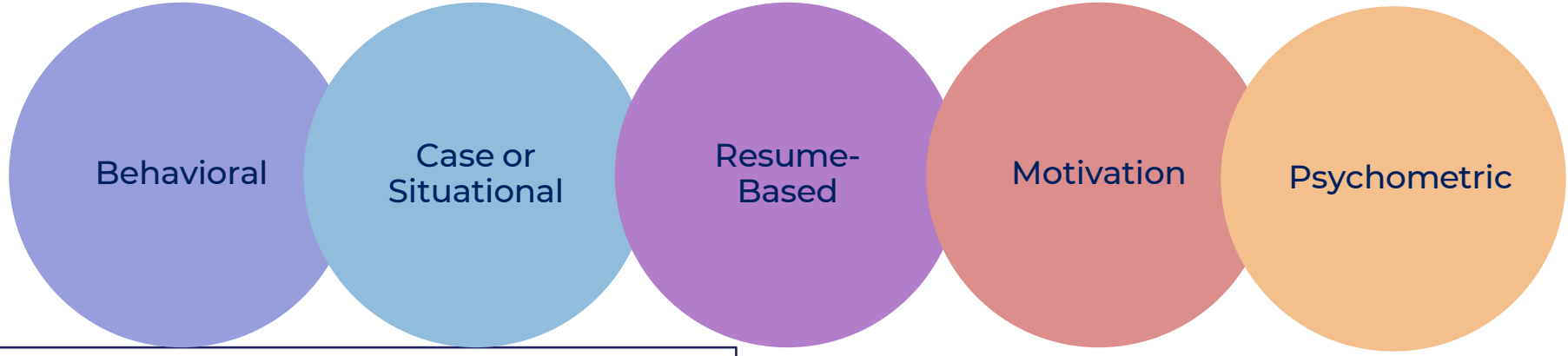
Interview Questions The STAR Interview Method



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Five Types of Interview Questions



Behavioral
Take examples of your past behavior to gauge how you will react in similar situations in the future.

Case or Situational
Evaluate your problem solving and analytical abilities.

Resume-Based
Gain a better understanding of the experience presented on your resume.

Motivation
Understand your motivation for applying to the position and the organization.

Psychometric
Understand how you think, behave, and make decisions, rather than what's on your resume

Behavioral Question Examples
- ✓ Tell me about a time when...
- ✓ Give me an example...

Case or Situational Question Examples
- ✓ How would you...
- ✓ What would you do...

Resume-Based Question Examples
- ✓ Your resume says you increased sales at your last job, can you tell me more about this?

Motivation Question Examples
- ✓ What drew you to this position?
- ✓ Why do you want to work with this organization?

Psychometric Question Examples
- ✓ Aptitude test
- ✓ Skills test
- ✓ Personality test

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Interview Question Examples - 1

Behavioral Questions

- ✓ Explain the most difficult problem you had to solve in the last year. Describe what you did to create the solution to that problem.
- ✓ Pick an example from your current job that best reflects your ability to deal with pressure.
- ✓ Describe a time when you were not effective in managing a conflict situation with a co-worker.
- ✓ Talk about a time when you had to work closely with someone whose personality was very different from yours.
- ✓ Give me an example of a time you faced a conflict while working on a team. How did you handle that?
- ✓ How do you organize your work? Describe a time when you were extremely busy and had to make tough choices about what to prioritize.
- ✓ Tell me about a time you needed to get information from someone who wasn't very responsive.
- ✓ Give me an example of when you were able to persuade someone to see things your way at work.
- ✓ Tell me about a time you were dissatisfied in your work. What could have been done to make it better?

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Interview Question Examples - 2

Case or Situational Questions

- ✓ Describe a difficult situation you have encountered at work and how you handled it?
- ✓ Describe a time when you had a heavy workload and how you handled it.
- ✓ Describe a time when you interacted with a difficult client. How did you handle it?
- ✓ What would you do if you made a mistake that no one else noticed? Would you address the error and risk slowing things down or ignore it to keep the project or task moving forward?
- ✓ What would you do if you were asked to perform a task you've never done before?
- ✓ Tell me about a time when you failed. How did you deal with this experience?
- ✓ What professional accomplishment are you most proud of and how did you achieve it?

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Interview Question Examples - 3

Resume-Based Questions

- ✓ You mentioned html experience in your resume, can you please tell when and how you used this?
- ✓ You mentioned volunteer experience in your resume, can you please elaborate on your experience?
- ✓ What skills have you gained from previous work experiences that will be transferable to this position?

Motivation Questions

- ✓ What goals, including career goals, have you set for your life? Do you have a career plan?
- ✓ What are you passionate about?
- ✓ How would you define success for your career? At the end of your work life, what must have been present for you to feel as if you had a successful career?
- ✓ What inspires you to work in this industry?
- ✓ What role does your manager or supervisor play in your personal motivation at work?
- ✓ Observing your coworkers, in your current or a past job, describe what actions, interactions, and encouragement motivated their best performance.
- ✓ What actions, behaviors, or workplace events, would limit or destroy your workplace motivation?
- ✓ How do you ensure that your personal level of motivation is high on a daily basis?

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Interview Question Examples - 4

Psychometric Questions

Strongly Agree -> Strongly Disagree questions

- ✓ Personality & Work Style - These look at how you typically behave at work.
  - ✓ I prefer working alone rather than in a team.
  - ✓ I stay calm under pressure.

- ✓ Values & Ethics - Used to see if you align with the company's culture.
  - ✓ If I see a coworker breaking a rule, I should report it.
  - ✓ It's acceptable to bend rules to get results.

- ✓ Emotional Intelligence - Measures how you handle emotions—yours and others'.
  - ✓ I can tell when someone is uncomfortable even if they don't say it.
  - ✓ I get frustrated easily when things don't go as planned.

- ✓ Situational Judgment - These may be multiple choice.
  - ✓ A teammate is not contributing to a group project. What do you do?
  - ✓ You are given conflicting deadlines by two supervisors. What do you prioritize?

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The STAR Interview Method

S	Situation	Briefly explain the situation
T	Task	Your role in the situation and level of responsibility
A	Action	Action you took to overcome the challenges
R	Result	How the situation was resolved



Why You Should Use the STAR Method

- ✓ The STAR method helps you give a detailed answer to the interview questions and hit all the key points the interviewer will be looking for in your response.
- ✓ Using the STAR method to prepare for your interview ahead of time will help you identify your professional skills and accomplishments and how they relate to the position you are applying for.
- ✓ You can prepare good responses using real-life examples.

STAR can often be used for interview questions that begin with the following:

- ✓ Tell me about a…
- ✓ Describe a situation…
- ✓ Give me an example of…
- ✓ Have you ever…

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How to Use STAR

- Using STAR, you can create a story with a conflict and resolution. Here is what each part of the STAR format includes:

- **Situation:** The candidate describes the scene and provides relevant details of their example. Employers look for an answer that explains the context of the situation and why it connects to their question.

- **Task:** Next, the candidate describes their role in the situation. This can help the employer determine what level of responsibility they had in their previous roles.

- **Action:** They explain how they addressed the situation and what steps they took to overcome the challenge. A good answer shows how the candidate added value to the situation and made logical decisions.

- **Result:** At the end of their answer, the candidate explains the outcome of the situation. A quality answer includes concrete examples and quantifiable achievements. They should explain the direct effects of their efforts in their answer.

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STAR Examples

Example STAR Questions

- ✓ Have you ever had to work with limited resources? What did you do to adapt?
- ✓ Tell me about one of your greatest achievements. How did you get there?
- ✓ Describe a situation where you made a mistake. What did you do to fix it?
- ✓ Give me an example of when you led a team during a challenging time.

- **Example STAR Response**
- **Situation:** "When I worked at the garden nursery, one customer was upset that we did not have her favorite tulips in stock."

- **Task:** "As the customer service representative, it was my responsibility to think of a solution to her problem. A major part of my job was to make sure the customers left the store happy."

- **Action:** "After checking our inventory, I saw that she was incorrect, so I kindly explained that we moved the tulip display. I guided her to the display. She said that we didn't have enough for her garden, so I contacted our seller to speed deliver more of the bulbs."

- **Result:** "Since I took the time to work with this customer, she went from upset to happy during our interaction. Later that evening, I noticed that she left us a 5-star online review and mentioned my name."

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Further Discussion

Questions to Ask Your Mentor

- ✓ Do you have an example of a STAR from your interviews?
- ✓ Of the four types of interview questions which have you had the most?
- ✓ What are common mistakes you see people make?
- ✓ How do I handle questions about conflict, failure, or feedback?
- ✓ If you were interviewing, what would concern you?
- ✓ Is there anything I should be asking that I am not?

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Action Items Before Next Session

Before Session 8

- ✓ Practice STAR answers for at least five common interview questions using ‘Worksheet: STAR Practice’ before the next session. Have at least five stories of past experiences written down prior to having an interview.
- ✓ Continue applying for positions using LinkedIn and other job searching tools to work toward goal of setting up at least five job interviews prior to college graduation.
- ✓ Mark Session 7 as complete on the Student Portal

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Interview Questions

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The STAR Interview Method

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